

cookie

A packet of data sent by a website to a user's computer that is used to identify the user and track their browsing.

cryptocurrency

A wholly digital form of currency that operates without a central bank.

cybersecurity

The protection of computers and data from attacks by malicious people online.

dark web

The most restricted part of the internet, viewable only by using a special web browser.

data

Information that is processed or stored by a computer.

database

A program that lets people store and search data effectively.

debugging

The process of finding and fixing bugs (errors) in programs.

decomposition

The process of breaking a problem down into smaller sub-problems.

decryption

The process of using a cipher and a key to reveal the meaning of encrypted text.

deep web

The part of the internet that is not listed on search engines.

digital

Involving the use of computer technology, or the use or storage of data as digital signals. Digital signals are expressed in 0s and 1s.

digital divide

The difference between people who have access to digital devices and the internet, and those who do not.

digital identity

The set of identifiers used by organizations to authenticate who a user is, so the user can access the organization's services.

digital literacy

The ability to be able to find, use, and share accurate information online.

encoding

The process of turning information, such as images, sounds, or text, into a format a computer can understand.

encryption

The process of making a message unreadable to everyone except the person or people it was intended for.

file

A resource for storing information on a computer.

firmware

A type of program that is embedded into a device's CPU and controls how the device works.

function

A mathematical formula that takes input data and acts upon it to produce output data. Functions are made up of variables, constants, and arrays.

functional language

A programming language that defines a program as a series of mathematical functions.

geek

An informal term for someone who is obsessive about a certain topic, or group of related topics.

gender gap

The difference in status, opportunities, and attitudes between men and women.

hacking

Any act that makes a piece of technology do something it wasn't intended to do. Hackers can be grouped into white, grey, and black hat hackers, depending on their intentions.

hardware

The physical parts of a computer that exist as objects in the real world.

heuristic

Any approach to problem-solving or learning that uses a quick and simple approach as opposed to a thorough one. A "rule of thumb" is an example of a heuristic.

hub

The central part of a network, through which information flows into and out of the network.

Hypertext Markup Language (HTML)

A programming language for creating webpages and web applications. HTML is divided into elements called tags, semantics, and attributes that each hold a specific type of information.

Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP)

The data transfer protocol used on the world wide web.

imperative language

A programming language that operates as a series of commands that are executed one by one.

input

Any information that is put in, taken in, or operated on by a process or system.

internet

A massive global network of created from connections between billions of computers.